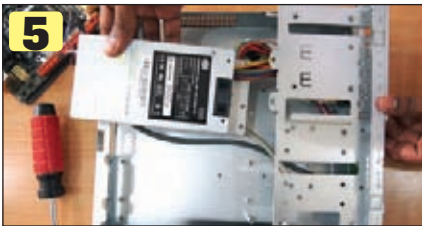


Core i3-2100T vs AMD E350

Xbit labs has done an in-depth testing of the entry-level low power Sandy Bridge processor with its AMD counterpart: <http://goo.gl/UDihP>

Adobe Flash 11 beta

Adobe has released the beta versions of Flash Player 11 and AIR 3 runtimes



Detach the power supply and the top panel on the left-hand side (let's call it 'A') to allow the motherboard to be easily lodged.



Attach the hard drive on the underside of panel A with the help of additional screws found in the cabinet's box.



Put the back I/O shield in place. Be careful with the sharp edges found on most of these back I/O panels.



Place the motherboard in place and make sure that the screw holes on the board correspond with those on the cabinet. Once in place, screw the motherboard to the cabinet.



Refer to your motherboard manual to connect the Power LED, HDD LED, USB and audio front panel cables. You may leave the HDD LED disconnected if the blinking light is distracting



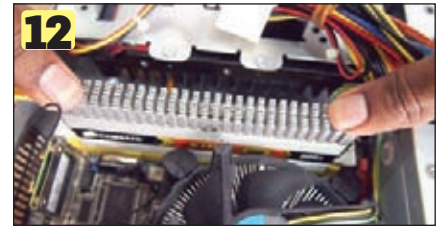
The next step is to connect the 24-pin motherboard power cable into the motherboard coming from the power supply. You'll also notice a four-pin CPU power cable, make sure you connect that to your motherboard as well. Once that's done, connect your SATA cable and power cable to the HDD.



Next, we install the CPU and heat sink. Align the processor according to the notches.

While Assembling

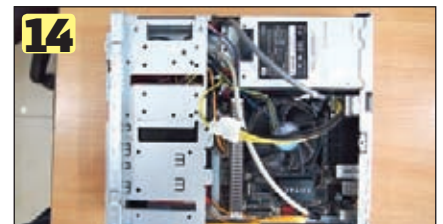
- Ground yourself before handling the motherboard by just a wall or just standing barefoot on the ground.
- Most heat sinks will have some thermal paste stuck on its base, but if yours doesn't, ensure that you put a drop of thermal paste on top of the lodged processor.
- Make sure that you choose your cabinet wisely so that there's enough space for adding components in the future if you so need. In our assembly, we didn't have space to add a discrete graphics card as we didn't feel the need for one.
- Once done with the wiring, tie the stray wires with zip ties so that the wiring looks clean and doesn't block the air flow in the cabinet.



With the above done, you can now install your RAM. Again be careful and work in an anti-static environment.



After installing all the components and fixing Panel A which holds the HDD, you'll notice that the wires are all over the place.



You'll have to find a way to manage the wires, else the cabinet won't close. We nudged the wires just behind the power supply to get a clean rig before closing it.



After all the steps above, close the lid on the top and attach the screws in place. Your HTPC is now ready to be powered up.